

TEMPLATE P41 · DECLARATIONS OF INDEPENDENCE AND CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

# Declarations of independence and conflicts of interest

Provides three models — the annual declaration by members of the bodies, the AI Auditor's declaration of independence and the declaration of independence and interests by the consultant or external adviser — and maintains the register of declarations and abstentions.

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**Why it matters.** Segregation of duties only protects if it is known who has interests in what. A prior declaration makes it possible to abstain, replace or reinforce verification before deciding; without it, a conflict is discovered when it has already biased a *gate*, a supplier assessment or an audit. Failing to declare a conflict that has affected a *gate* decision is a major nonconformity (30 §12), and a *gate* verified by an auditor who is not independent must be verified again (38 §3.1).

## Instructions for use

| Aspect                         | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>When it is used</b>         | Model A: on joining a body, once a year and whenever a conflict arises. Model B: before each audit or verification engagement. Model C: at the start of any audit (M3) or board advisory (M4) service, at the start of the mandate of the director or adviser with AI experience, and whenever the situation changes (91 §5.5; 61 §10.3). |
| <b>Who completes it</b>        | The declarant.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Who verifies it</b>         | The AI Office with compliance assesses A declarations (30 §12); the head of AI audit, B declarations; the board secretariat or the body commissioning the service, C declarations.                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Who decides or approves</b> | Whoever assesses decides the measure; if it concerns a director, the board's conflict of interest regime applies (CI-6).                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Stage or moment</b>         | C2 and C5 (annual renewal of A declarations); at each Enterprise <i>gate</i> the AI Auditor checks that they are on record (30 §12, step 5).                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Tool</b>                    | T01 · Initiative register: conflicts and abstentions alongside the affected decision (30 §13).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Reference document</b>      | 30 §5.2 and §12; 38 §3.1; 91 §5; 61 §10.3; P03 §8.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

Completion rules:

- Conflicts of the **roles in an initiative** are declared in P03 §8; this template covers **members of bodies, auditors** and **third parties**, and consolidates the company register.
- **Actual, potential or apparent** conflicts are declared; another person carries out the assessment.
- A "no conflicts" declaration is also signed and recorded.
- Proposed code: **DCI-AAAA-NNN** (declaration of conflicts and independence), sequential per year.

## Identification

| Field       | Content       | Guidance |
|-------------|---------------|----------|
| <b>Code</b> | DCI-AAAA-NNN. |          |

| Field                                  | Content                                                                                         | Guidance |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Model                                  | A Member of a body · B AI Auditor · C Consultant or external adviser.                           |          |
| Declarant and position or organisation |                                                                                                 |          |
| Body, engagement or service            | Body of which the declarant is a member; initiative, <i>gate</i> or audit; service model M1–M5. |          |
| Period covered                         | Financial year or duration of the engagement.                                                   |          |
| Date of the declaration                | DD-MM-AAAA.                                                                                     |          |
| Reason                                 | Joining · Annual renewal · New engagement · Change of situation.                                |          |

### 03

## Model A · Annual declaration by members of bodies

For members of the board, the board committee and the AI Committee, and heads of the AI Office (30 §12).

| #  | Question                                                                                                                                                                              | Yes · No | Details                            |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| A1 | Do you sponsor or have a build role in any AI initiative decided by the body? (CI-1)                                                                                                  |          | IA-AAAA-NNN codes.                 |
| A2 | Does your variable remuneration depend on the <b>declared</b> value of AI initiatives? (CI-2)                                                                                         |          | Objective and metric.              |
| A3 | Do you or a related person have an employment, commercial, shareholding or advisory relationship with an AI supplier of the company or one taking part in an assessment? (CI-3, CI-6) |          | Supplier and type of relationship. |
| A4 | Have you participated in the previous twelve months in the design of controls or in the operation of systems that the body oversees? (I-10)                                           |          |                                    |
| A5 | Do you have volume targets for initiatives in production? (CI-5)                                                                                                                      |          |                                    |
| A6 | Is there any other circumstance that may affect your impartiality in AI matters?                                                                                                      |          |                                    |

**Declaration.** [Full name], member of [body] of [the Company], declares that the above information is complete and truthful, that they will abstain on matters in which they have a conflict and that they will notify [the secretariat of the body] of any change as soon as it occurs. Date and signature.

04

## Model B · AI Auditor's declaration of independence

Before each engagement, with the levels in 38 §3.1. It is also signed by the technical experts supporting the auditor.

| #  | Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                     | Met<br>(Yes ·<br>No) | Details or<br>safeguard       |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------|
| B1 | <b>Organisational.</b> My function reports functionally to the board committee and not to areas that sponsor the audited initiative.                                                            |                      |                               |
| B2 | <b>Individual.</b> I have had no role in the initiative or in the design, build or operation of the system.                                                                                     |                      |                               |
| B3 | <b>Individual.</b> I do not report hierarchically to the sponsor (I-5).                                                                                                                         |                      |                               |
| B4 | <b>Individual.</b> I have not advised on the audited controls in the previous twelve months (I-10).                                                                                             |                      |                               |
| B5 | <b>Economic.</b> I do not audit solutions that I or my organisation have designed, implemented or sold, or products of related companies (I-11); my remuneration does not depend on the result. |                      |                               |
| B6 | <b>Rotation.</b> I have not been the lead auditor of this Enterprise system for more than [three] consecutive financial years.                                                                  |                      | Number of<br>financial years. |
| B7 | <b>Threats.</b> I identify no self-review, self-interest, familiarity, intimidation or dependence on the auditee for technical evidence, or I state the safeguard applied.                      |                      |                               |

**Declaration.** [Full name], AI Auditor assigned to [engagement or *gate*] of [initiative or system], declares that they meet the above requirements and undertakes to notify the head of AI audit immediately of any circumstance that compromises their independence. Date and signature.

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## Model C · Declaration of independence and interests by the consultant or external adviser

Minimum content of 91 §5.5, with the situations in 91 §5.4 and 61 §10.3.

| Field                                                                  | Content | Guidance                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Service requested                                                      |         | M1 Diagnosis · M2 Implementation · M3 Audit · M4 Board advisory · M5 Ongoing support.                                                                          |
| Scope                                                                  |         | Initiatives, systems, processes or registers affected.                                                                                                         |
| Services provided to the company and its group in the last three years |         | Model, scope and dates.                                                                                                                                        |
| Compatibility according to 91 §5.2                                     |         | Compatible · Compatible with caution · Incompatible, and cooling-off period (91 §5.3).                                                                         |
| Relationships with technology or model suppliers                       |         | Alliances, commissions, resale.                                                                                                                                |
| Fee structure                                                          |         | If there are variable fees, only on value validated by management control or by an unrelated audit.                                                            |
| Sale of own tools                                                      |         |                                                                                                                                                                |
| People assigned                                                        |         | And whether any has worked in the company or in the scope during the cooling-off period.                                                                       |
| Personal or corporate relationships with directors or executives       |         |                                                                                                                                                                |
| Director or adviser with AI experience                                 |         | Incompatibility with implementation services in the initiatives they oversee; access to information through the board secretariat; confidentiality (61 §10.3). |

**Declaration.** [Organisation or person], in relation to [service] for [the Company], declares that the above information is complete, that none of the incompatibilities in 91 §5.2 applies and that it will notify any change to the body commissioning the service. Date and signature.

06

## Assessment and measure

Procedure of 30 §12: declaration, assessment, measure, record and check.

| Field                                    | Content                                                          | Guidance                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conflict identified                      |                                                                  | Question or requirement affected.                                                                       |
| Type                                     |                                                                  | Actual · Potential · Apparent.                                                                          |
| Measure                                  |                                                                  | Abstention · Replacement · Additional verification · Board conflict regime · No measure (give reasons). |
| Matters or decisions affected            |                                                                  | IA-AAAA-NNN, <i>gate</i> , engagement, P14 assessment.                                                  |
| Assessed by and date                     |                                                                  | Different from the declarant.                                                                           |
| ( <i>illustrative example</i> ) Conflict | A3: close family member employed by a supplier under assessment. | Actual · Abstention from the assessment and the contracting decision.                                   |

07

## Register of declarations

| Code         | Model     | Declarant | Body or engagement | Date | Conflict declared (Yes · No) | Measure | Next renewal | Status                         |
|--------------|-----------|-----------|--------------------|------|------------------------------|---------|--------------|--------------------------------|
| DCI-AAAA-NNN | A · B · C |           |                    |      |                              |         |              | In force · Lapsed · Superseded |

| Code                                         | Model | Declarant | Body or engagement | Date       | Conflict declared (Yes · No) | Measure | Next renewal | Status   |
|----------------------------------------------|-------|-----------|--------------------|------------|------------------------------|---------|--------------|----------|
| ( <i>illustrative example</i> ) DCI-2026-004 | A     | Person D  | AI Committee       | 01-11-2026 | No                           | —       | 01-11-2027   | In force |

08

## Register of abstentions

| Date | Body and meeting | Matter | Person | Reason (applicable CI or I) | Linked declaration | Resolution in minutes (P39) |
|------|------------------|--------|--------|-----------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|
|      |                  |        |        |                             | DCI-AAAA-NNN       |                             |

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## Quality criteria

| # | Check                                                                                                                  | Status                                   |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1 | All members of bodies have a Model A declaration in force for the financial year.                                      | Met · Not met · Not applicable · Pending |
| 2 | Each auditor and expert on an engagement signed the Model B declaration before starting (38 §3.1).                     |                                          |
| 3 | Every M3 or M4 service and every director or adviser with AI experience has a Model C declaration (91 §5.5; 61 §10.3). |                                          |
| 4 | Each conflict has a type, a measure and an assessor other than the declarant.                                          |                                          |
| 5 | Abstentions are recorded in the minutes and in T01 alongside the affected decision.                                    |                                          |
| 6 | The AI Auditor checked the declarations at each Enterprise <i>gate</i> .                                               |                                          |
| 7 | Incompatibilities I-5, I-10 and I-11 of 30 §5 are respected.                                                           |                                          |

# Approval and verification

| Function                   | SEVEN-G role                                          | Name and position | Date | Signature or reference |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------|------------------------|
| Declares                   | Member of a body · AI Auditor · Consultant or adviser |                   |      |                        |
| Assesses (Model A)         | AI Office with compliance                             |                   |      |                        |
| Assesses (Model B)         | Head of AI audit                                      |                   |      |                        |
| Assesses (Model C)         | Board secretariat or body commissioning the service   |                   |      |                        |
| Checks at Enterprise gates | AI Auditor                                            |                   |      |                        |

Segregation of duties: nobody assesses their own declaration; the declarations of the head of the AI Office are assessed by compliance, and those of the head of AI audit by the board committee.

# Version control

## Completed document

| Version | Date | Author | Changes |
|---------|------|--------|---------|
|---------|------|--------|---------|

## Template

| Version | Date       | Changes                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0.1     | 19-09-2026 | First version. Three declaration models (30 §12, 38 §3.1, 91 §5.5 and 61 §10.3) and registers of declarations and abstentions; proposes the code DCI-AAAA-NNN. |